



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Valor San Antonio

School Website: <https://www.valoreducation.org/sanantonio/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Valor San Antonio, TX (78228) presents a robust alignment with classical education through its explicit emphasis on a classical curriculum, memorization, Great Books, Latin, and a deliberately virtue- and beauty-centered vision. Public materials from Valor loudly foreground a formation-oriented mission, a reverence for truth, goodness, and beauty, and a culture of community that includes families and extended stakeholders. The school's rhetoric and curricular signals indicate a strong classical orientation, particularly in its curriculum (Great Books, poetry memorization, Latin, nature study, fine arts) and its stated aims (cultivation of virtue and wisdom; formation over information). However, several hallmark features of a fully classical program—explicit, widespread emphasis on Trivium/Quadrivium disciplines (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) as foundational liberal arts; a consistently Socratic/Harkness pedagogy; explicit liturgical/theological integration; and a fully explicit, cohesive “living curriculum” manifested in pedagogy across all grade bands—are less clearly articulated in the public-facing materials. As a result, Valor San Antonio is best characterized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall, with strong strands in curriculum and purpose that anchor it toward CLASSICAL, and with some missing or less explicit marks in theology-liturgical integration, explicit Trivium/Quadrivium framing, and pedagogy that foreground Socratic discourse and scholastic-style contemplative practice.

What moves Valor San Antonio toward full CLASSICAL are concrete shifts that make its classical commitments more explicit and systematically implemented at every category: articulate and publish an explicit Trivium/Quadrivium framing, integrate theology or a robust Christian worldview within the Great Books and history sequence, expand and document a consistent Socratic/Harkness pedagogy across upper grades, and foreground liturgical or communal practices that align with traditional classical patterns of formation. Strengthening family partnerships with clearly defined roles in formation, and documenting faculty development as a living curriculum anchored in classical methods, would further reinforce the classical identity.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** Valor emphasizes transcendental aims (Truth, Goodness, Beauty) and moral formation; explicit theology and liturgical practice are less evident in public materials. Positive keywords around truth/goodness/beauty and moral formation appear, but explicit theological grounding or liturgical practices are not clearly stated in the public-facing content. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Present positive indicators include truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, and moral formation. Negatives (or gaps) include limited explicit theology and liturgical references in the public site. Why this rating: The school's mission centers on transcendent aims and moral formation but does not consistently articulate theological grounding or liturgical practice in the site materials, limiting a full CLASSICAL alignment in this category.
- **Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** The school's stated aim is formation through virtue and wisdom, not merely job preparation; the environment is described as cultivating truth, goodness, and beauty; channeled through a curriculum that seeks moral and intellectual growth. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, human flourishing, truth/goodness/beauty, contemplation about the good life. No strong negative signals in the public materials. Why this rating: Valor's framing centers on forming virtuous, wise humans and a transrational telos grounded in transcendental values, aligning well with CLASSICAL standards for purpose and goal.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The curriculum emphasizes memoriza-

tion of poetry, Great Books, nature studies, Latin, and the fine arts; documents reference a classical curriculum and curriculum-at-a-glance materials. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include Great Books, poetry memorization, Latin, nature studies, and the arts. There is strong signal for classical content, though explicit mention of grammar, logic, and rhetoric (the traditional Trivium) is not clearly articulated in public copy. Why this rating: The visible curriculum signals strongly toward classical elements (Great Books, memory work, Latin, arts) but lacks explicit, public articulation of the full Trivium/Quadrivium framing and direct statements about history-as-liberal-arts-integrated across disciplines. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL placement rather than CLASSICAL.

- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: Public content highlights memory-based work (poetry memorization), Great Books discussions, and a strong emphasis on formation. It is less explicit about a rigorous Socratic seminar culture or dedicated scholé/restful days in a school-wide pedagogy. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include memorization, great books, dialogue around literature and philosophy; potential negative signals include lack of explicit Socratic/SCHOLÉ pedagogy or restfulness in classroom culture in public copy. Why this rating: Valor demonstrates core classical pedagogy signals (memory, Great Books, rhetoric-upholding practices like recitation), but lacks explicit, public, scalable articulation of a full Socratic/seminar-based upper-level pedagogy and scholé-restful instruction throughout the grades. This positions pedagogy as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: The school presents itself as guided by a Headmaster and a living-curriculum ethos; there is a clear emphasis on recruiting teachers who instantiate virtues and excellence, and the website directly points to a faculty/staff directory and a culture of mentorship. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include teacher as exemplar, virtue, mentorship, living curriculum, character formation; lack of explicit negative signals in the public copy. Why this rating: Valor's leadership language and directed emphasis on teacher virtue and mentorship align with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty, marking this category as CLASSICAL.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: The site features family-focused materials (Family Handbook, FAQs, parent-facing content, donation pages) and emphasizes partnership with families; there are explicit calls for parental involvement and to visit. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, parent formation, family involvement, home-school partnership; presence of donation/friend-raising signals community engagement. No overt negative signals in public materials. Why this rating: Valor's public materials strongly signal a CLASSICAL orientation in parents and community, with explicit language about partnerships and family involvement.

Aggregate Assessment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- The school shows a solid CLASSICAL core (purpose-focused on virtue/wisdom, classical curriculum signals, strong faculty-community signals). However, gaps remain in fully explicit theology/ liturgical integration, and in publicly articulated Trivium/Quadrivium framing and an explicitly defined Socratic pedagogy across all grades. These gaps prevent a full CLASSICAL rating across all categories, yielding an overall SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL classification.

What Would Move the Needle - Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Add explicit theology grounding and liturgical/communal practices within the curriculum and site materials; consistently reference a theological framework or confessionally-informed worldview, if applicable to the school's identity. - Element 3 (Curriculum): Publicly articulate and publish a formal Trivium/Quadrivium framing, including explicit grammar, logic, rhetoric, and the quadrivium disciplines as foundational across the grade bands; ensure history is taught as liberal-arts history rather than solely as social studies; emphasize and document Great Books as a central spine with primary sources. - Element 4 (Pedagogy): Implement and publicize a consistent Socratic/Harkness-based pedagogy for upper grades; bolster the role of scholé (restful learning) and contemplative activities in the daily schedule; demonstrate how memory work, recitation, and disciplined dialogue integrate with inquiry-based learning. - Element 5 (Faculty): Deepen the living-curriculum model by clearly documenting teacher development in classical pedagogy; publish profiles of exemplary teachers

and a teacher-formation plan aligned with classical aims; elevate teacher-student mentorship as a visible, ongoing program. - Element 6 (Parents & Community): Expand parent-formation offerings (book studies, lectures, seminars) with a published calendar and outcomes; maintain open-visit policies with structured parent-involvement roles that align with classical formation and family catechesis where appropriate.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.